Zerodha Coin SIP case: Part 3 interviews and survey

Oct 29, 2026

Who to talk to

Talk to people whose first ever mutual fund investment was a SIP, started 1 to 24 months ago, ideally on Coin. Recruit on purpose for people who had a failed instalment or stopped. A random sample would be mostly happy, active investors.

What the discovery engine says about the audience

Signal from the 1,245 tagged posts	What it means for recruiting
70 of the 84 posts about a failed or stuck SIP come from Play Store and App Store reviews, 79 of them from 2023 on, mostly from current investors	People with failures are recent, active app users. Find them among Coin and Kite users, not only on forums
49 of the 63 posts about stopping, pausing or considering it come from Reddit and YouTube; 13 are from people who already stopped	Stoppers talk in communities. Reddit and investing groups are where to find them
133 posts are from people about to start, and their top worry is setting up (37 posts)	Recent starters remember set-up best. Include some who started in the last 3 months
Age is stated in only 20 posts (17 of them under 35); income and money source almost never	The engine can't describe the audience by age or income. The screener and survey must ask

Who qualifies. Their first ever mutual fund investment was a SIP; they started it 1 to 24 months ago; they are not finance professionals.

Who doesn't. People who held funds before their first SIP; anyone working in fund distribution, advice or a fintech (especially Zerodha); people who never completed a SIP set-up.

Quotas

Group	Branch it tests	Interviews (6)	Survey (target 40)
Had at least one failed or missed instalment	B	2	12 or more
Paused or stopped their SIP (one who stopped after a failure, if possible)	C, D	2	10 or more
Started in the last 3 months	A	1	6 or more
Still active, no problems	Comparison group	1	The rest

- **Platform:** at least 4 of 6 interviewees use Coin. The others can use another app as a comparison. The survey takes any app and asks which one.
- **Timing:** at least half started 12 or more months ago, because only they can tell us whether they were active at month 12.
- **Where to recruit:** the same places as the engine's sources. Reddit (r/IndiaInvestments, r/mutualfunds, r/personalfinanceindia), college and workplace groups, LinkedIn, and friends of friends. Reddit users know more than average, so don't fill quotas from Reddit alone.

Screener

Eight short questions, sent as a form before booking anyone. They take about a minute, qualify the person and place them in a quota group. The same questions open the survey.

#	Question	Options	Rule
1	Have you ever invested in a mutual fund?	Yes / No	No → thank and end
2	Was your very first mutual fund investment a SIP?	Yes / No, a one-time investment / Not sure	Only "Yes" qualifies for interviews
3	When did you start your first SIP?	Under 1 month ago / 1–3 months / 4–12 months / 13–24 months / Over 2 years	Interviews: 1–24 months only

#	Question	Options	Rule
4	Which app did you start it on?	Zerodha Coin or Kite / Groww / Paytm Money / ET Money / Bank app / Fund house website / Through a distributor / Other	Count toward the 4-of-6 Coin quota
5	Which best describes that first SIP today?	Still running / Paused / I stopped it / It stopped without me stopping it / Not sure	Places them in a quota group
6	Has an instalment ever not gone through?	Yes / No / Not sure	"Yes" or "Not sure" → failure group
7	Do you work in mutual fund distribution, financial advice or a fintech company?	Yes / No	Yes → exclude
8	Your age range, and your work	Under 22 / 22–25 / 26–30 / 31–35 / Over 35; Salaried / Self-employed / Student / Other	Profile only; fills the gap the engine left

Ask nothing else at this stage: no fund names, amounts or account details.

Interview guide

A 35-minute conversation that walks through the person's SIP story in order, so the failure and stopping moments come up without being asked about directly. Each block tests one branch of the metric tree; the probes go in only if the story doesn't get there by itself.

Rules for the interviewer

- Ask what happened, not what they would do. "Tell me about the last time" beats "Would you ever".
- Don't name a problem before they do. Never ask "did your payment fail?" until they bring it up.
- No advice. If they ask which fund to pick, say that's outside this conversation.
- Never ask for PAN, account numbers, amounts beyond a range, or screenshots of their portfolio.

1. Opening (3 min)

1. Thank them, say what it's for (a student product case), and that there are no right answers.
2. Ask for consent to take notes, or to record if they agree, and say recordings are deleted once notes are written.

2. Starting (branch A, 7 min)

1. Take me back to when you started your first SIP. What made you start then?
    - Probe: who or what pointed you to it? Why that app?
2. Walk me through setting it up, step by step, as you remember it.
    - Probe: anything confusing? Anything you had to look up?
3. How long until the first instalment went through? How did you know it had?

3. How the money moves (branches A and B, 7 min)

1. How does the money get from your bank to the fund each month?
    - Probe: do you know if it's UPI Autopay, a bank mandate, or paying by hand?
2. When is your SIP date, and when does your salary or income arrive?
    - Probe: how did you pick the date?
3. Do you check anything around the SIP date? What do you look at?

4. Month to month (branch B, 8 min)

1. Has there been a month when something didn't go as expected with your SIP? Tell me about it.
    - Probe: how did you find out, and how long after? What did the app show?
    - Probe: what did you do next: pay by hand, wait, contact support, delete it?
    - Probe: did the bank charge you anything?
2. If nothing went wrong: how would you know if it had?

5. When it changed (branches C and D, 7 min)

Only for people who paused or stopped.

1. Tell me about the moment you paused or stopped. What was going on?
    - Probe: was it a decision, or did it just stop working?
    - Probe: did you know pausing was possible? Did you look at it?
2. What would have needed to be different for you to keep going?

For people still active:

1. Has there been a time you thought about stopping? What kept you going?

6. Close (3 min)

1. If you could change one thing about how SIPs work in your app, what would it be?

2. Anything I should have asked but didn't?
3. Thank them. Ask if they'd try an early version of a fix later (for Part 6 user testing).

Survey

A 5-minute form for 30 to 50 people. It asks for an email, then 7 of the 8 screener questions (not the one on working in finance), then the 12 below; every question feeds a number in Part 2 or tests a branch. At 40 responses, a percentage is good to about ±15 points, so read results as direction, not precision.

#	Question	Options	Feeds
S1	Roughly how much do your SIPs add up to each month?	Under ₹1,000 / ₹1,000–2,999 / ₹3,000–4,999 / ₹5,000–9,999 / ₹10,000 or more / No SIP running now	Replaces the ₹3,230 average in sizing
S2	How are your instalments paid?	UPI Autopay / Bank mandate (e-NACH) / I pay by hand each time / Not sure	A: does the user know how money moves?
S3	When you set it up, how clear was it how the money would be taken each month?	Very clear / Somewhat clear / Not clear	A
S5	If an instalment ever failed: how did you find out?	App notification / Email or SMS / Saw it in the app myself / Bank message or statement / Found out much later / Never sure	B: awareness
S6	How long after it failed did you find out?	Same day / Within a week / Over a week / Never really found out	B: silent lapses
S7	What did you do next?	Paid it by hand / Waited for next instalment / Fixed the mandate / Contacted support / Paused or deleted the SIP / Nothing	B: recovery

#	Question	Options	Feeds
S8	What caused it, as far as you know?	Not enough balance on the date / Mandate or autopay problem / App or payment error / Changed bank / Don't know	B: failure mix
S10	In the month before your SIP's 1-year mark, did an instalment go through?	Yes / No / Not sure / My SIP is less than 13 months old	Self-reported 12-month continuation
S11	If you paused or stopped: what were the main reasons? (Up to two; skip if not)	Needed the money / Returns disappointed me / Market fell / Payments kept failing / It stopped without me deciding / Moved to another app or investment / Someone advised me / Other	C and D: why people stop
S12	Did you know you could pause a SIP instead of stopping it?	Yes, and I used it / Yes, but didn't use it / No	D
S13	What one change would most help you keep your SIP going?	Free text	Ideas for Part 5
S14	Would you be up for a 30-minute chat?	Yes / No	Interview recruiting, using the email given

S4 (days to first instalment) and S9 (SIP date versus income) were dropped to keep the form short. The interviews still cover both.

Screener question 2 (first investment a SIP) replaces the 70% assumption in sizing. Keep the app question (screener 4) and report every number twice: Coin users only, and all apps. The ready-to-send Google Form adds a consent question, and asks "Have you ever started a SIP?" so people without one finish early.

Running it

Run the survey first: its answers fill the interview quotas and give you people to call.

Form set-up

- Show S5 to S8 only to people who answered "Yes" or "Not sure" to screener question 6. S10 and S11 go to everyone, with a way to say they don't apply.
- Let anyone who has invested in a fund take the survey, even if their first investment wasn't a SIP. Excluding them would make the share who start with a SIP look like 100%.

Privacy and consent

- Never collect PAN, account or folio numbers, exact amounts, fund names or portfolio screenshots.
- Say at the start what the answers are for. The form requires an email address: use it only to follow up, and move that column out of the sheet before analysis.
- Name interviewees P1 to P6 in all notes. Delete any recording once its notes are written.

Note template (one row per interviewee)

Person	Group	Started (A)	Money moves (A, B)	Failures (B)	Stopping or pausing (C, D)	Best quote	Surprise
P1							
P2							
P3							
P4							
P5							
P6							

Analysis

1. Tally survey answers for each question, and split them by quota group and by Coin versus other apps.
2. Replace the sizing assumptions in Part 2: the share starting with a SIP (screener question 2) and the average amount (S1).
3. For each branch, write one line: confirmed, contradicted or unclear, with the count behind it (for example, "failed and found out over a week later: 7 of 14").
4. Optionally run the anonymised interview notes through the discovery engine's tagging step, and compare the themes with the public posts. Log it in the AI Evidence Log if you do.
5. Rewrite the problem statement if the interviews say otherwise. The deck should show what changed.

Survey results

33 people answered by 1 November 2026. Failed instalments are common (9 of 33 said yes or not sure) but were mostly fixed. The 5 who stopped or paused gave deliberate reasons (money, returns, market), not failed payments. Most respondents are experienced investors, so the survey describes people who stayed more than first-timers at risk.

Who answered

- 28 of 33 started their first SIP over a year ago (20 over two years ago); only 5 in the last 12 months.
- 25 of 33 are aged 26–30, 27 are salaried, and 19 put ₹10,000 or more a month into SIPs.
- 9 started on Zerodha, 8 through an agent or distributor, 7 on Groww, 5 on a bank app, 4 elsewhere.

Findings by branch

Branch	Finding	What it means
Sizing	First investment was a SIP: 25 of 33 (76%)	Replaces the 70% guess. It sits inside the range, but a survey about SIPs over-recruits SIP investors
Sizing	19 of 33 invest ₹10,000+ a month	Far above the ₹3,230 industry average: keep the industry figure for sizing
A. Starts well	All 33 found set-up very or somewhat clear; all know how they pay (17 bank mandate, 15 UPI Autopay, 1 by hand)	No set-up problem in this group, but they are experienced. Test with recent starters
B. Keeps working	9 of 33 had a failure or aren't sure. Causes: mandate or autopay 4, short balance 3, don't know 2. 3 of 9 found out over a week later. 5 fixed it, 3 waited for the next month, 1 paused or deleted	Failures are frequent and sometimes noticed late, but experienced investors recover
B, Coin only	4 of 9 Coin users vs 5 of 24 on other apps. 3 of the 4 Coin cases were mandate problems; 2 found out over a week later	Fits Coin's no-retry rule, but 9 people is far too few to conclude anything

Branch	Finding	What it means
C. Wants to continue	4 stopped, 1 paused; only 1 of the 5 had a failure. Reasons: needed the money 2, returns disappointed 2 (one also cited the market), market fell 1	Stops in this group are decisions, not silent lapses
C, all answers	21 people gave a reason, 16 of them still running (probably about past pauses or other SIPs): returns disappointed 10, needed the money 9, market fell 4, moved elsewhere 4, someone advised 2	Disappointing returns matter more than the public posts suggested
D. Adjusts	26 of 33 know they can pause (18 have); 7 don't, including 2 of the 5 who stopped or paused	Pausing is known, but not to everyone who quits
Main metric	Of 32 old enough: instalment around the 1-year mark: yes 19, no 4, not sure 9	Many can't recall, so self-reported continuation is a weak measure

What changes

- The problem statement gets a second half. Failures are frequent and sometimes noticed late (B), but deliberate stops come from money needs and disappointing returns (C).
- Branch B stays the most controllable, but this survey does not show failures causing stops. The interviews must test whether that is only because these respondents are experienced.
- The sample is the wrong mix. Get 10 to 15 more responses from people who started in the last 12 months, such as juniors and first-job groups.

Interview picks (from the 14 who agreed; sheet row numbers, emails stay in the sheet)

Sheet row	App	Why this person	Branch
34	Zerodha	Failed instalment from a mandate problem, found out over a week later	B
27	Zerodha	Not sure if one failed; mandate problem; found out over a week later	B
2	Zerodha	Started under a month ago and already had a failure. Some answers conflict, so check them	A, B

Sheet row	App	Why this person	Branch
8	Zerodha	Started 13–24 months ago, still running, no problems	Comparison
5	Other	Stopped after a failed instalment (short balance)	C, D
13	Other	Stopped, didn't know pausing existed, not active at the 1-year mark	C, D

Backups: rows 14 and 4 (Zerodha), 11 (another app, had a failure) and 7 (another app, started 4–12 months ago).

Mentor checks this part answers

Check	How Part 3 answers it
1. Clarity	One audience definition and one quota table; every question names the branch it tests
5a. Data justifies decisions	The audience and quotas come from discovery-engine counts, not guesses
5b. Target segment size	The survey replaces both sizing assumptions: share starting with a SIP, and average amount
5c. Metrics defined and chosen	S10 gives a self-reported 12-month continuation; S5 to S8 give the branch B inputs
4a. Solution addresses the problem	The interviews confirm or kill the problem before any solution is built
5h. Usability testing	Not here, but the close asks each interviewee to test the MVP later (Part 6)